

BRIAN J. BALES

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer with experience building internal production tools, full-stack SaaS applications, and AI-powered workflows across entertainment and enterprise environments. Skilled in React, JavaScript/TypeScript, Python, Node.js, SQL, REST APIs, and cloud platforms. Proven ability to partner with business stakeholders, translate operational needs into technical solutions, troubleshoot integrations, and rapidly learn new platforms.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI Engineer | Handshake AI

Jan 2026 - Present

- Evaluate frontier AI model outputs across coding and technical reasoning tasks, assessing accuracy, logic, instruction-following, completeness, and edge cases.
- Create structured technical feedback and response-validation workflows that help improve model quality and reliability.
- Apply software engineering judgment to identify faulty assumptions, implementation defects, and unsafe or unsupported conclusions in AI-generated responses.

Software Engineer | FOX Entertainment

Feb 2025 - May 2025

- Developed React-based internal applications supporting production workflows across shows, episodes, and deliveries; rapidly iterated UI/UX with stakeholders using AI-assisted development tools.
- Built a full-stack integration connecting Linear task data to custom frontend interfaces, giving production teams clearer visibility into work status and operational progress.
- Engineered scalable filtering and navigation components for large production datasets, reducing friction when locating operational content.
- Partnered with production and technical teams to translate workflow pain points into practical features used by internal users.

Software Developer | FOX Corporation

Sep 2024 - Dec 2024

- Developed Salesforce Playbook tools for production scheduling and workforce coordination using JavaScript, Lightning Web Components, Apex, and HTML/CSS.
- Integrated crew availability, project workload, and scheduling data into a unified SaaS workflow to improve production coordination.
- Collaborated with engineers, product managers, and business stakeholders in Agile environments to refine requirements, test changes, and deliver platform enhancements.
- Quickly learned Salesforce platform development and applied web engineering fundamentals to custom interfaces, backend logic, and workflow automation.

Software Developer | Highstreet IT Solutions

May 2021 - Dec 2022

- Configured and customized Oracle Student Financial Planning systems supporting financial aid workflows for 1,000+ university students.
- Developed backend workflow logic using Groovy and SQL to automate eligibility checks, award processing, and financial aid operations.
- Troubleshoot data and system issues across interconnected workflows, improving process accuracy and reliability for administrators and students.
- Partnered with financial aid stakeholders to translate policy and operational requirements into tested enterprise-system updates.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Pixloo.AI - Generative AI Creation Platform | *Flutter, Node.js, Express, Supabase, Fly.io, Vercel, Replicate*

- Built a full-stack iOS platform that enables non-technical users to generate AI-powered images and videos through a unified mobile experience.
- Designed backend APIs for authentication, cloud storage, model routing, parameter controls, and asynchronous media-generation workflows.
- Integrated multiple external AI models and generation modes, including text-to-image, image-to-image, text-to-video, image-to-video, and motion-control workflows.
- Used Cursor with MCP integrations, custom rules, reusable Skills, and AI agents to accelerate API integration, debugging, and implementation while maintaining manual engineering review.

Dreamcatcher - AI Dream Journal & Interpretation Platform | *Flutter, Supabase, AI APIs, Cursor*

- Built a full-stack mobile application that transforms dream journal entries into structured AI interpretations and personalized visual experiences.
- Designed AI workflows that combine user input, prompt orchestration, interpretation logic, and media-generation.
- Implemented authentication, cloud storage, journal/calendar data, and backend services for persistent user experiences.
- Used Google Stitch, MCP-based design handoffs, Cursor agents, and project-specific rules to move from UI concepts to maintainable application code.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, SQL, Groovy, Java, C++, HTML/CSS

Frontend & Mobile: React, Angular, Next.js, Vue.js, Flutter, Lightning Web Components, Material UI

Backend & Integration: Node.js, Express, REST APIs, Supabase, Firebase/Firestore, PostgreSQL, authentication, API integrations

AI & Developer Tools: Cursor, Claude, GitHub Copilot, Google Stitch, Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, custom rules and Skills, prompt engineering, Replicate, Fal.AI

Platforms & Data: Salesforce, Vercel, Fly.io, Git/GitHub, Jira, Figma, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib

AI-ASSISTED ENGINEERING WORKFLOW

- Created structured Cursor workflows using MCP integrations, project-specific rules, reusable Skills, and specialized agents for implementation, debugging, and code review.
- Used Google Stitch and MCP-based handoffs to translate UI concepts into application code while preserving architecture and design-system consistency.
- Combined AI-assisted development with manual validation of architecture, security, API behavior, and production reliability.

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

IEEE Publication | CSU ScholarWorks - GA-SFS Hybrid Feature Selection for Biomedical Data

- Designed a hybrid feature-selection algorithm combining Genetic Algorithms with Sequential Floating Forward Selection for high-dimensional biomedical datasets.
- Evaluated selected feature subsets with SVM and KNN classifiers using Python, scikit-learn, NumPy, Pandas, and Matplotlib.
- Published the completed research through IEEE and CSU ScholarWorks.

EDUCATION

California State University, Northridge | M.S. Software Engineering

California State University, Northridge | B.S. Computer Science

CERTIFICATION & LANGUAGES

Certified Salesforce AI Associate | English and Spanish (Fluent)